

APTITUDE AND FOUNDATIONAL VALUES FOR CIVIL SERVICE

APTITUDE, ATTITUDE AND VALUE → INTEGRITY UNDER DISCRETION: THE → IMPARTIALITY IS NOT IDENTICAL → NON-PARTISANSHIP AND THE TRANSFER → EMPATHY, SYMPATHY AND COMPASSION → ENABLER VERSUS REGULATOR: CALIBRATION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 APTITUDE, ATTITUDE AND VALUE: THE THREE-OBJECT TAXONOMY

APTITUDE, ATTITUDE AND VALUE THE THREE-OBJECT TAXONOMY CENTRAL FOCUS 1. APTITUDE, ATTITUDE AND VALUE [1] APTITUDE IS CAPACITY TO PERFORM A TASK OR [2] ATTITUDE IS AN EVALUATIVE STANCE TOWARD A SPECIFIC [3] VALUE IS A GENERAL CROSS-SITUATIONAL STANDARD OF WORTH. [4] APTITUDE IS TRAINABLE THROUGH DELIBERATE PRACTICE AND MENTORING.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[4] Aptitude is trainable through deliberate practice and mentoring.	VERDICT → Classify the object of assessment precisely before applying it to a civil-service case.
1. Aptitude, attitude and value: the three-object taxonomy	[5] Attitude can change with experience; values are more enduring.	ANSWER USE → Open foundational-values answers by distinguishing what is being assessed.
[1] Aptitude is capacity to perform a task or role competently.	[6] Recruitment tests primarily measure aptitude and intelligence.	MUST REMEMBER: Aptitude is learnable capacity for role performance
[2] Attitude is an evaluative stance toward a specific object.	[7] Probation and appraisal assess dedication and initiative.	integrity aligns justified values, words and action, impartiality avoids irrelevant preference, non-partisanship avoids party allegiance, objectivity uses relevant
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• CENTRAL FOCUS	• [4] Aptitude is trainable through deliberate practice and mentoring.	• VERDICT → Classify the object of assessment precisely before applying it to a civil-service case.
• 1. Aptitude, attitude and value: the three-object taxonomy	• [5] Attitude can change with experience; values are more enduring.	• ANSWER USE → Open foundational-values answers by distinguishing what is being assessed.
• [1] Aptitude is capacity to perform a task or role competently.	• [6] Recruitment tests primarily measure aptitude and intelligence.	• MUST REMEMBER: Aptitude is learnable capacity for role performance
• [2] Attitude is an evaluative stance toward a specific object.	• [7] Probation and appraisal assess dedication and initiative.	• integrity aligns justified values, words and action, impartiality avoids irrelevant preference, non-partisanship avoids party allegiance, objectivity uses relevant
• [3] Value is a general cross-situational standard of worth.	• [8] Confusing the three weakens assessment design and answers.	

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Classify the object of assessment precisely before applying it to a civil-service case.

01

STAGE 01 INTEGRITY UNDER DISCRETION: THE HARDEST TEST

INTEGRITY UNDER DISCRETION THE HARDEST TEST CENTRAL FOCUS 2. INTEGRITY UNDER DISCRETION [1] INTEGRITY MEANS CONSISTENCY OF VALUES ACROSS SITUATIONS. [2] THE NOLAN COMMITTEE TREATS INTEGRITY AND HONESTY AS [3] INTEGRITY IS COSTLESS TO DISPLAY WHEN OBSERVED. [4] IT IS GENUINELY TESTED WHEN DISCRETION, SECRECY AND

CENTRAL FOCUS		
2. Integrity under discretion: the hardest test	→ [1] Integrity means consistency of values across situations.	→ [2] The Nolan Committee treats integrity and honesty as separate principles.
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• CENTRAL FOCUS • 2. Integrity under discretion: the hardest test • [1] Integrity means consistency of values across situations. • [2] The Nolan Committee treats integrity and honesty as separate principles.	• [3] Integrity is costless to display when observed. • [4] It is genuinely tested when discretion, secrecy and gain converge. • [5] The state cannot legislate integrity directly. • [6] It legislates proxies: asset declarations and conflict disclosures.	• [7] Random inspections and cooling-off periods add observable checks. • [8] Integrity proxies monitor behaviour but cannot guarantee character. • VERDICT → Integrity is the precondition for every other foundational value to be trustworthy. • ANSWER USE → Use the discretion-secrecy-gain test to show how integrity is operationally assessed.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Integrity is the precondition for every other foundational value to be trustworthy.

02

STAGE 02 IMPARTIALITY IS NOT IDENTICAL TREATMENT

IMPARTIALITY IS NOT IDENTICAL TREATMENT CENTRAL FOCUS 3. IMPARTIALITY IS NOT IDENTICAL TREATMENT [1] IMPARTIALITY REQUIRES DECISIONS ON MERIT WITHOUT PERSONAL BIAS. [2] IT DOES NOT REQUIRE IDENTICAL TREATMENT REGARDLESS OF [3] NEEDS-BASED SUPPORT FOR WEAKER SECTIONS CAN BE IMPARTIAL [4] THE CRITERION IS WHETHER DIFFERENTIATION IS TRANSPARENT AND [5] A PUBLISHED FEE WAIVER FOR BPL APPLICANTS IS

CENTRAL FOCUS		
3. Impartiality is not identical treatment	→ [1] Impartiality requires decisions on merit without personal bias.	→ [2] It does not require identical treatment regardless of need.
CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• CENTRAL FOCUS	• [3] Needs-based support for weaker sections can be impartial	• [7] The safeguard is transparent eligibility, not removal of discretion

- VERDICT → Integrity is the precondition for every other foundational value to be trustworthy.
- ANSWER USE → Use the discretion-secrecy-gain test to show how integrity is operationally assessed.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Integrity is the precondition for every other foundational value to be trustworthy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Test the criteria, not the outcome, to distinguish impartiality from favouritism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Non-partisanship is an institutional-design achievement, not just a personal virtue.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Compassion earns marks only when it changes a defensible administrative process.

EMPATHY, SYMPATHY AND COMPASSIONAN ASCENDING LADDERCENTRAL FOCUS5. EMPATHY, SYMPATHY AND COMPASSION[1] SYMPATHY FEELS FOR SOMEONE FROM OUTSIDE WITH AN[2] EMPATHY GRASPS ANOTHER'S SITUATION FROM THEIR FRAME OF[3] COMPASSION ADDS A MOTIVATED COMMITMENT TO RELIEVE SUFFERING.[4] ONLY COMPASSION NECESSARILY ISSUES IN ACTION OR SERVICE

CENTRAL FOCUS

5. Empathy, sympathy and compassion: an ascending ladder

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. Empathy, sympathy and compassion: an ascending ladder
- [1] Sympathy feels for someone from outside with an implicit hierarchy.
- [2] Empathy grasps another's situation from their frame of reference.

MECHANISM

- [3] Compassion adds a motivated commitment to relieve suffering.
- [4] Only compassion necessarily issues in action or service design.
- [5] A social media statement of sorrow is sympathy, not compassion.
- [6] Listening to displaced families and adjusting relief is empathy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Redesigning pension verification for disabled applicants is compassion.
- [8] GS-IV answers must translate feeling into a process change.
- VERDICT → Compassion earns marks only when it changes a defensible administrative process.
- ANSWER USE → Use the ladder to escalate from sentiment to service-design in any answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Compassion earns marks only when it changes a defensible administrative process.

05

STAGE 05

ENABLER VERSUS REGULATOR: CALIBRATION SPECTRUM

ENABLER VERSUS REGULATORCALIBRATION SPECTRUMCENTRAL FOCUS6. ENABLER VERSUS REGULATOR[1] FACILITATION REMOVES BARRIERS AND PROACTIVELY CONNECTS CITIZENS TO[2] REGULATION PROTECTS SAFETY, EQUITY AND PUBLIC INTEREST.[3] SINGLE-WINDOW CLEARANCE CONSOLIDATES MULTIPLE APPROVALS FOR LOW-RISK CASES.[4] POST-FACTO RISK-BASED INSPECTION REPLACES UNIVERSAL EX-ANTE GATEKEEPING.

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. Enabler versus regulator: calibration spectrum

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Enabler versus regulator: calibration spectrum
- [1] Facilitation removes barriers and proactively connects citizens to services.
- [2] Regulation protects safety, equity and public interest.

MECHANISM

- [3] Single-window clearance consolidates multiple approvals for low-risk cases.
- [4] Post-facto risk-based inspection replaces universal ex-ante gatekeeping.
- [5] Deemed approval shifts incentive from delay to timely review.
- [6] Pure facilitation without backstops risks regulatory capture.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Excessive regulation without enabling stifles legitimate development.
- [8] Calibration requires reliable risk-classification systems.
- VERDICT → The civil servant should sequence facilitation and regulation, not choose one exclusively.
- ANSWER USE → Use to build the calibrated-role paragraph in any enabler-regulator question.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The civil servant should sequence facilitation and regulation, not choose one exclusively.

06

STAGE 06

MISSION KARMAYOGI: VALUES AS TRAINABLE COMPETENCIES

MISSION KARMAYOGIVALUES AS TRAINABLE COMPETENCIESCENTRAL FOCUS7. MISSION KARMAYOGI[1] NPCSCB APPROVED BY CABINET ON 2 SEPTEMBER 2020.[2] FRAC MAPS FUNCTIONAL AND BEHAVIOURAL COMPETENCIES TO ROLES.[3] IGOT-KARMAYOGI DELIVERS LEARNING IN 23 LANGUAGES.[4] KCM ALIGNS ROLES WITH COMPETENCIES AND SUPPORTS ACCOUNTABILITY

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Mission Karmayogi: values as trainable competencies

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Mission Karmayogi: values as trainable competencies
- [1] NPCSCB approved by Cabinet on 2 September 2020.
- [2] FRAC maps functional and behavioural competencies to roles.

MECHANISM

- [3] iGOT-Karmayogi delivers learning in 23 languages.
- [4] KCM aligns roles with competencies and supports accountability and role-fit (CBC).
- [5] AI Sarthi and AI Tutor showcased at IndiaAI Impact Summit (16-20 Feb 2026) for role-based personalised learning (CBC).
- [6] Training reach does not prove ethical internalisation.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Do not claim a general APAR linkage without a service-specific DoPT order.
- [8] Values training needs supplementation by citizen feedback and field observation.
- VERDICT → Mission Karmayogi institutionalises values education; it cannot certify ethical conduct.
- ANSWER USE → Cite as the institutional bridge between values and role-based capacity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Mission Karmayogi institutionalises values education; it cannot certify ethical conduct.

07

STAGE 07

COMPASSION VERSUS FAVOURITISM: THE BOUNDARY

COMPASSION VERSUS FAVOURITISMTHE BOUNDARYCENTRAL FOCUS8. COMPASSION VERSUS FAVOURITISM[1] COMPASSIONATE FACILITATION USES TRANSPARENT PUBLISHED CRITERIA.[2] FAVOURITISM USES INFORMAL SELECTION WITHOUT PUBLISHED JUSTIFICATION.[3] BOTH MAY LOOK IDENTICAL IN FORMEXPEDITED SERVICE FOR ONE PERSON.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Compassion versus favouritism: the boundary
- [1] Compassionate facilitation uses transparent published criteria.

MECHANISM

- [3] Both may look identical in form: expedited service for one person.
- [4] The distinguishing test is whether criteria are rule-based and auditable.
- [5] Written reasons for each discretionary decision create an audit trail.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Affirmative needs-based support passes the test; selective favour fails it.
- [8] The safeguard is transparency, not the removal of all discretion.
- VERDICT → Compassion and impartiality coexist when discretion operates within published rules.

APTITUDE AND FOUNDATIONAL VALUES FOR CIVIL SERVICE • TILE 3/5 • same master rows 4645-7879 of 12524 • continues below

- VERDICT → Mission Karmayogi institutionalises values education; it cannot certify ethical conduct.
- ANSWER USE → Cite as the institutional bridge between values and role-based capacity.

- [7] Affirmative needs-based support passes the test; selective favour fails it.
- [8] The safeguard is transparency, not the removal of all discretion.
- VERDICT → Compassion and impartiality coexist when discretion operates within published rules.
- ANSWER USE → Use to resolve the compassion-favouritism tension in welfare-delivery answers.

- [7] Tolerance does not require approval; it requires equal respect and access.
- [8] Constitutional morality disciplines personal prejudice with public duty.
- VERDICT → Tolerance becomes a foundational administrative value through constitutional morality.
- ANSWER USE → Use to anchor diversity and secularism answers in specific constitutional provisions.

dedication is sustained public commitment, not obedience to an unlawful superior

- VERDICT → Know both lists and where they diverge to avoid a false equivalence trap.
- ANSWER USE → Use the overlap and gaps to answer any Nolan or foundational-values comparison.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Tolerance is principled forbearance, not approval of injustice
- dedication is sustained public commitment, not obedience to an unlawful superior
- political neutrality does not mean value-neutrality toward constitutional rights.

[3] ELECTION DUTY TESTS IMPARTIALITY UNDER DIRECT POLITICAL PRESSURE.

10. Nolan seven versus GS-IV syllabus list	[5] Dedication to public service overlaps with Nolan's selflessness.	ANSWER USE → Use the overlap and gaps to answer any Nolan or foundational-values comparison.
[1] Nolan lists selflessness, integrity, objectivity as shared with GS-IV.	[6] The two lists are complementary, not identical.	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Tolerance is principled forbearance, not approval of injustice
[2] Nolan adds accountability, openness, honesty and leadership.	[7] Equating them without qualification is a common exam trap.	dedication is sustained public commitment, not obedience to an unlawful superior
CORE CLAIM • CENTRAL FOCUS • 10. Nolan seven versus GS-IV syllabus list • [1] Nolan lists selflessness, integrity, objectivity as shared with GS-IV. • [2] Nolan adds accountability, openness, honesty and leadership. • [3] GS-IV adds empathy, tolerance and compassion toward weaker sections.	MECHANISM • [4] Non-partisanship appears in GS-IV but not explicitly in Nolan. • [5] Dedication to public service overlaps with Nolan's selflessness. • [6] The two lists are complementary, not identical. • [7] Equating them without qualification is a common exam trap. • [8] Indian civil-service ethics must address both frameworks.	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • VERDICT → Know both lists and where they diverge to avoid a false equivalence trap. • ANSWER USE → Use the overlap and gaps to answer any Nolan or foundational-values comparison. • CLOSE DISTINCTION: Tolerance is principled forbearance, not approval of injustice • dedication is sustained public commitment, not obedience to an unlawful superior • political neutrality does not mean value-neutrality toward constitutional rights.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Know both lists and where they diverge to avoid a false equivalence trap.		

10

STAGE 10 VALUES UNDER PRESSURE: AN INTEGRATION MAP		
VALUES UNDER PRESSURE	AN INTEGRATION MAP	CENTRAL FOCUS
11. VALUES UNDER PRESSURE	[1] DISCRETION CREATES THE SPACE IN WHICH INTEGRITY IS	[2] POLITICAL TRANSITION TESTS NON-PARTISANSHIP MOST SHARPLY.
[4] WELFARE DELIVERY TESTS COMPASSION ALONGSIDE IMPARTIAL RULE-APPLICATION.		[3] ELECTION DUTY TESTS IMPARTIALITY UNDER DIRECT POLITICAL PRESSURE.
CORE CLAIM • CENTRAL FOCUS • 11. Values under pressure: an integration map • [1] Discretion creates the space in which integrity is tested. • [2] Political transition tests non-partisanship most sharply. • [3] Election duty tests impartiality under direct political pressure.	MECHANISM • [4] Welfare delivery tests compassion alongside impartial rule-application. • [5] Gender-specific challenges test impartiality reflexively. • [6] Service-delivery redesign tests compassion as operational output. • [7] Enabler-regulator framing tests dedication and objectivity together. • [8] Each value interacts with others under realistic administrative stress.	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • VERDICT → Foundational values are tested in combination, not in isolation. • ANSWER USE → Use to show multi-value interaction in any pressure-scenario question. • EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: Civil-service values must be operationalised through recorded reasons, recusal, consultation, accessibility, competence, • Mission Karmayogi is a capacity framework, not evidence that every official possesses these values.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Foundational values are tested in combination, not in isolation.		

11

STAGE 11 PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS		
PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS	CENTRAL FOCUS	12. PYQ AND ANSWER SYNTHESIS
[1] 2025 Q5(B) TESTED ENABLER-FACILITATOR WITH SPECIFIC MEASURES.	[2] 2025 Q4(A) TESTED OBJECTIVITY AND CRITICAL THINKING IN	[3] 2025 Q5(A) TESTED DEVOTION TO DUTY AND PERSONAL
[4] 2024 Q6(A) TESTED GENDER-SPECIFIC CHALLENGES AND PROBITY.	[5] 2018-2021 TESTED NOLAN PRINCIPLES, BUFFETT, AND NON-PARTISANSHIP.	
CENTRAL FOCUS	12. PYQ and answer synthesis	[1] 2025 Q5(b) tested enabler-facilitator with specific measures.
		[2] 2025 Q4(a) tested objectivity and critical thinking in welfare schemes.
		[3] 2025 Q5(a) tested devotion to duty and personal fulfilment.
CORE CLAIM • CENTRAL FOCUS • 12. PYQ and answer synthesis • [1] 2025 Q5(b) tested enabler-facilitator with specific measures. • [2] 2025 Q4(a) tested objectivity and critical thinking in welfare schemes.	MECHANISM • [3] 2025 Q5(a) tested devotion to duty and personal fulfilment. • [4] 2024 Q6(a) tested gender-specific challenges and probity. • [5] 2018-2021 tested Nolan principles, Buffett, and non-partisanship. • [6] Name the value precisely rather than listing adjectives.	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT • [7] Show the institutional mechanism that operationalises the value. • [8] Close with a qualified verdict acknowledging a real limitation. • VERDICT → The highest-scoring answer moves from value to pressure to mechanism to example to limit. • ANSWER USE → Use as the revision checklist before any foundational-values PYQ attempt.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The highest-scoring answer moves from value to pressure to mechanism to example to limit.		

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE		
OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT	1. ARCHITECTURE	2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS
	3. DETAILED TREATMENT	4. INSTITUTIONAL AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE
	5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES	6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS
		7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS
OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH • 1. Architecture • 2. Concepts and distinctions • 3. Detailed treatment • 4. Institutional and reform architecture	ADVANCED DEBATE • 5. Indian applications and boundary cases • 6. Limitations and trade-offs • 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims • 8. Advanced Prelims traps	LEGACY / NUANCE • 9. Current application • 10. PYQ-based analytical application • 11. Mains-ready framework • 12. Probable questions
OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.		